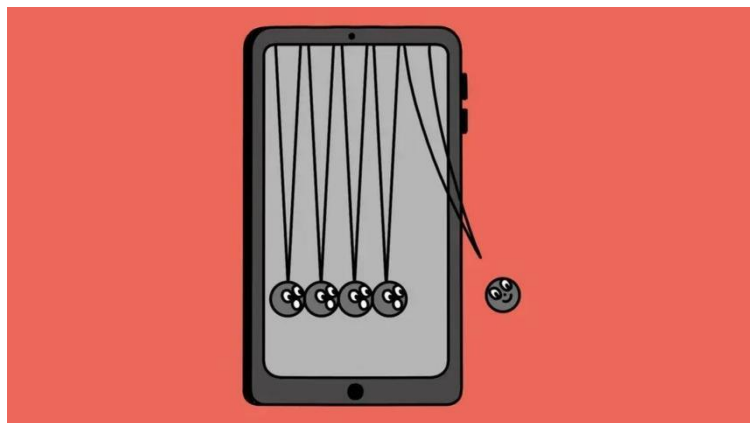


## 考研精读 | Economist



### Well Informed

### 应知尽知

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

How to stop **procrastinating**

如何停止拖延

#### 【 Para.1 】

Putting things off **exacts** a **hefty toll**. One study published in 2013 ranked 22,053 people on a procrastination scale of one to five. Each increase of one point was associated with a drop of nearly \$15,000 in annual earnings. Those who habitually engage in “self-regulatory failure”, as procrastination is also known, are more **prone** to delaying medical treatment. A study of 3,525 Swedish university students published in 2023 found that those who scored highly for procrastination were more likely to suffer **debilitating** pain.

拖延的代价十分高昂。2013年，有人发表了一项研究，他们针对22053人进行了评估，按照1至5分给拖延程度打分。研究显示，拖延程度每增加1分，年收入便会下降近15000美元。习惯性出现“自我调节失败”

## August 8TH- 14TH | Science & technology

### 文章导读：

多项研究证实拖延危害深远，不仅会减少收入，还易引发躯体疼痛、焦虑，甚至诱发抑郁。可行改善手段包含MCII心理训练与体育锻炼；饮食对拖延的影响尚无明确证据，暂无专用药物，但部分多动症药物有助于推动行动。智能手机带来诸多干扰，加剧拖延并形成恶性循环。

**procrastinate v.** /prəʊ'kræstneɪt/ (formal disapproving) to delay doing sth that you should do, usually because you do not want to do it 拖延；耽搁【考研英语大纲词汇】  
Most often we **procrastinate** when faced with something we do not want to do. 面对不想做的事情，我们经常拖延。

**exact v.** /ɪg'zækt/ to demand and get sth from sb 要求；索取【考研英语大纲词汇】  
She was determined to **exact** a promise from him. 她决意要他作出许诺。  
**adj. correct in every detail** 精确的；准确的  
What were his **exact** words? 他的原话是什么？

**hefty adj.** /'hefti/ large; larger than usual or expected 很大的；超出一般的；可观的【考研英语大纲词汇】

**toll n.** /təʊl/ the amount of damage or the number of deaths and injuries that are caused in a particular war, disaster, etc. (战争、灾难等造成的) 毁坏；伤亡人数【考研英语大纲词汇】  
**take a heavy toll (on sb/sth)/ take its toll (on sb/sth)** idiom to have a bad effect on sb/sth; to cause a lot of damage, deaths, suffering, etc. 产生恶果；造成重大损失（或伤亡、灾难等）  
The recession is taking its **toll** on the housing markets. 经济衰退使住房市场遭受着重大损失。

**prone adj.** /prəʊn/ (~ to sth/to do sth) likely to suffer from sth or to do sth bad 易于遭受；有做（坏事）的倾向【考研英语大纲词汇】

**debilitate v.** /dɪ'bɪlɪteɪt/ (formal) to make sb's body or mind weaker (使身心) 衰弱，衰竭，虚弱  
Chemotherapy exhausted and **debilitated** him. 化疗使他感到非常疲惫虚弱。

**meta-analysis n.** /,metə'ænalɪsɪs/ a research method that combines the results of several related studies to produce better results 元分析；荟萃分析（一种将多项独立研究结果进行统计学合并以得出综合结论的方法）

**erosion n.** /ɪ'rəʊʒ(ə)n/ the fact of a good quality or situation being gradually lost or destroyed 削弱；逐步的破坏【考研英语大纲词汇】

**curb v.** /kɜ:b/ to control or limit sth, especially sth bad 控制，抑制，限定，约束（不好的事物）【考研英语大纲词汇】  
A range of policies have been introduced aimed at **curbing** inflation. 为了抑制通货膨胀实施了一系列的政策。  
SYN restrain, check, control, limit, inhibit, suppress

（又名拖延症）的人，更容易延误就医。2023年，一项3525名瑞典大学生为样本的研究发现，拖延程度较高的人遭受致残性疼痛的概率更高。

## 【 Para.2 】

It gets worse. The same Swedish study also found procrastinators more prone to anxiety, stress and loneliness.

A 2025 **meta-analysis**, published in Frontiers in Psychiatry and covering 88 studies involving 63,323 people in 17 countries, found procrastination and its resulting **erosion** of self-esteem to be a predictor of future depression. How might procrastination be **curbed**?

不仅如此。这份瑞典的研究还发现，拖延者更容易出现焦虑、压力和孤独感。2025年，《精神病学前沿》上发表了一份荟萃分析，内容涵盖了17个国家的88项研究，共63323名参与者。分析发现拖延及其导致的自尊受损，可以作为抑郁症的预测指标。那么，如何才能遏制拖延呢？

## 【 Para.3 】

Mental exercises appear to help. One set is known as mental **contrasting** with **implementation** intentions (MCII). Popularised in a number of smartphone apps, the idea is simple: **picture** the benefits of achieving a goal; contrast that image with the main **obstacle**; and **devise** a **tactic** to overcome it. In two randomised trials reported in 2020 undergraduates were given online MCII exercises designed to reduce the delaying of bedtime, which research has linked

**contrast v. /kən'trɑ:st/** (~ A and/with B) to compare two things in order to show the differences between them 对比；对照 【考研大纲词汇】

It is interesting to contrast the British legal system with the American one. 把英国的法制与美国的加以对比很有意思。

**n. (~ between A and B) (~ to/with sb/sth)** a difference between two or more people or things that you can see clearly when they are compared or put close together; the fact of comparing two or more things in order to show the differences between them 明显的差异；对比；对照

The company lost \$7 million this quarter in contrast to a profit of \$6.2 million a year earlier. 这家公司本季度亏损了700万元，与去年同期620万元的赢利形成了对照。

**implementation n. /ˌɪmplɪmen'teɪʃ(ə)n/** the act of starting to use a plan or system (计划、系统的) 实施，执行 【考研大纲词汇】

**picture v. /'pɪktʃə(r)/** (~ sb as sth) to imagine sb/sth; to create an image of sb/sth in your mind 想象；设想；忆起 【考研大纲词汇】

We found it hard to picture him as the father of teenage sons. 我们很难想象他居然是有几个十几岁儿子的父亲了。

**obstacle n. /'ɒbstəkl/** (~ to sth/to doing sth) a situation, an event, etc. that makes it difficult for you to do or achieve sth 障碍；阻碍；绊脚石 【考研大纲词汇】

**devise v. /dɪ'vaɪz/** to invent sth new or a new way of doing sth 发明；设计；想出 【考研大纲词汇】

A new system has been devised to control traffic in the city. 控制城市交通的新系统已经设计出来。 SYN think up

**tactic n. /'tæktɪk/** (usually pl.) the particular method you use to achieve sth 策略；手段；招数 【考研大纲词汇】

**assess v. /ə'ses/** (~ sb/sth as sth) to make a judgement about the nature or quality of sb/sth 评估，评定（性质、质量） 【考研大纲词汇】

The young men were assessed as either safe or unsafe drivers. 这些年轻人被评定为谨慎驾驶员和不谨慎驾驶员两类。

**assign v. /ə'saɪn/** (~ sth to sb) (~ sb sth) to give sb sth that they can use, or some work or responsibility 分配（某物）；分派，布置（工作、任务等） 【考研大纲词汇】

The two large classrooms have been assigned to us. 这两间大教室分配给了我们。

**intensity n. /ɪn'tensəti/** the strength of something that can be measured such as light, sound, etc. (光、声等的) 强度 【考研大纲词汇】

**interval n. /'ɪntəvl/** a period of time between two events (时间上的) 间隔，间隙，间歇 【考研大纲词汇】

at (...) intervals idiom

(1) with time between 每隔...时间；间或；不时

Buses to the city leave at regular intervals. 开往城里的公共汽车每隔一定时间发出一班。

(2) with spaces between 每隔...距离；间隔

Flaming torches were positioned at intervals along the terrace. 走廊上间隔地插着燃烧着的火炬。

**speculate v. /'spekjʊleɪt/** (~ about/on sth) to form an opinion about sth without knowing all the details or facts 推测；猜测；推断 【考研大纲词汇】

We can speculate that the stone circles were used in some sort of pagan ceremony. 我们可以推测，这些石头排成的圆圈是用于某种异教崇拜仪式的。

to procrastination in general. They missed their intended bedtimes by around 38 minutes less each night than those in a control group given advice about healthy sleeping habits.

心理训练可以帮助遏制拖延症。其中，有一种方法叫做心理对照结合执行意图（MCII），现已被多款手机软件所应用。其原理非常简单：你要先想出实现目标后所能获得的好处；再将这一愿景与实现目标的主要障碍进行对照；然后制定一套克服障碍的策略。在2020年发表的两项随机试验中，一批本科生在线接受了MCII训练，旨在减少其延迟就寝行为；而既有研究表明，延迟就寝与拖延存在普遍关联。与仅接受健康睡眠习惯建议的对照组相比，接受MCII训练的学生每晚的就寝延迟时间平均减少了约38分钟。

#### 【 Para.4 】

Exercise shows promise too. A Chinese trial published in March **assessed** procrastination in 77 male teenagers. Those randomly **assigned** to 12 weeks of strength training, high-**intensity interval** training, or a combination of the two, showed “significant reductions” in putting things off. An earlier study of 564 Chinese university students, published in 2022, found that the most physically active also procrastinated less. The researchers **speculated** that overcoming the stress of **exertion** gave them a “sense of mastery” that boosted confidence and motivation.

锻炼同样具有积极成效。今年3月，中国研究人员发表了一项实验研究，他们对77名男性青少年的拖延情况进行了评估。参与人员被随机分配进行长达12周的力

**exertion** n. /ɪgˈzɜːʃn/ (also exertions [pl.]) physical or mental effort; the act of making an effort 努力；尽力；费力【考研英语词汇】

**hinder** v. /ˈhɪndə(r)/ (~ sb/sth from sth/from doing sth) to make it difficult for sb to do sth or sth to happen 阻碍；妨碍；阻挡【考研英语词汇】

An injury was **hindering** him from playing his best. 受伤后他无法发挥出最高水平。

SYN hamper, impede, obstruct, inhibit, retard, thwart

**intriguing** adj. /ɪnˈtriːɡɪŋ/ very interesting because of being unusual or not having an obvious answer 非常有趣的；引人入胜的；神秘的【考研英语词汇】

**deficit** n. /ˈdefɪsɪt/ a lack of something that is needed 不足；缺乏【考研英语词汇】

**hyperactivity** n. /ˌhaɪpəˈrækˈtɪvəti/ (of a person) the state of having more energy than is normal, becoming excited easily, and being unable to stay still or think about work 多动亢奋，过分活跃【考研英语词汇】

**cognitive** adj. /ˈkɒɡnətɪv/ connected with mental processes of understanding 认知的；感知的；认识的（注意重音）【考研英语词汇】

**executive** adj. /ɪgˈzekjʊtɪv/ relating to the management and carrying out of plans, decisions, or tasks 执行的【考研英语词汇】

**stimulant** n. /ˈstɪmjələnt/ a substance that makes you more active and energetic 兴奋剂；刺激物【考研英语词汇】

**lisdexamfetamine** n. /ˌlɪsdeksæmˈfetəmiːn/ a prescription medication used to treat attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) and binge-eating disorder; it is a prodrug that is converted into dexamphetamine in the body 赖右苯丙胺（一种处方药，用于治疗注意缺陷多动障碍和暴食症）

**placebo** n. /pləˈsiːboʊ/ (pl.-os) a substance that has no physical effects, given to patients who do not need medicine but think that they do, or used when testing new drugs (给无实际治疗需要者的) 安慰剂；（试验药物用的）无效对照剂【考研英语词汇】

n. something that is given to try to satisfy a person who has not been given the thing they really want 使人宽慰的事；安抚话

**distraction** n. /dɪˈstrækʃn/ a thing that takes your attention away from what you are doing or thinking about 分散注意力的事；使人分心的事【考研英语词汇】

**scroll** v. /skrɔʊl/ to move text on a computer screen up or down so that you can read different parts of it 滚屏；滚动【考研英语词汇】

Use the arrow keys to **scroll** through the list of files. 用箭头键把文件目录滚动一遍。

**impede** v. /ɪmˈpiːd/ (formal) to delay or stop the progress of sth 阻碍；阻止【考研英语词汇】

Work on the building was **impeded** by severe weather. 楼房的施工因天气恶劣而停了下来。

ANT facilitate, promote, expedite, accelerate

**dawdle** v. /ˈdɔːd(ə)l/ to take a long time to do sth or go somewhere 拖延；磨蹭；游荡【考研英语词汇】

Eleanor will be back any moment, if she doesn't **dawdle**. 如果埃莉诺不磨蹭，她马上就会回来了。

量训练、高强度间歇训练或两者结合训练，结果发现，他们的拖延行为均出现了“显著减少”。2022年，另一项针对564名中国大学生的早期研究发现，身体活动最积极的学生拖延程度也最低。研究人员推测，克服运动带来的压力，能让他们产生一种“掌控感”，从而增强人的自信和动力。

### 【 Para.5 】

Then there is the question of diet and other habits. A 2024 study of Italian university students found higher procrastination among breakfast-skippers, heavy drinkers and poor sleepers. The researchers speculated that missing the energy from breakfast might **hinder** “motivation and ability to focus on tasks”. But the skipped breakfasts may have been a consequence of procrastination, rather than a cause: studies have yet to show convincingly that diet affects it.

此外，还需要考虑饮食以及其他生活习惯的问题。一项2024年针对意大利大学生的研究发现，不吃早餐、过量饮酒以及睡眠质量较差的人，拖延程度更高。研究人员推测，缺少早餐所提供的能量可能会妨碍“完成任务的动力和专注力”。但他们之所以不吃早餐，或许恰恰也是拖延所导致，而非拖延的原因。目前尚无研究能够令人信服地证明饮食会影响拖延行为。

### 【 Para.6 】

As for medications, none as yet targets procrastination. But an **intriguing** finding emerged in 2021 from an American

## 今日句子分析

Para. 3 In two randomised trials reported in 2020 undergraduates were given online MCII exercises designed to reduce the delaying of bedtime, which research has linked to procrastination in general. 在2020年发表的两项随机试验中，一批本科生在线接受了MCII训练，旨在减少其延迟就寝行为；而既有研究表明，延迟就寝与拖延存在普遍关联。



主句：

地点状语：In two randomised trials; (randomised由动词演变而来，randomised trial字面意思是“被随机化的试验”，实际上表示的就是“随机试验”，这个表达在医学、心理学等研究领域中很常见。但相比于randomised，我们或许更熟悉的是random，但区别在于，random trial更侧重于这个试验具有“随机”的性质，而randomised trial则更有种“研究人员对参与者进行了随机分配”的意味。虽然二者含义相似，但所指却有着微妙的差异。)

后置定语：reported in 2020;

主语：undergraduates; 谓语：were given; 宾语：online MCII exercises;

后置定语：designed to reduce the delaying of bedtime;

(主句部分有好几处后置定语，一般情况下，汉语习惯将后置定语提前，例如online MCII exercises designed to reduce the delaying of bedtime也许会被翻译为“旨在减少延迟就寝行为的线上MCII训练”，但定语较长，再衔接前文，“本科生接受了.....的线上MCII训练”就更加不自然。为避免这类问题，这部分译文主要是时间前置 (reported in 2020)，被动改主动 (undergraduates were given online MCII exercises—一批本科生在线接受了MCII训练，在较为正式或科研相关的语境内，英语常用被动语态体现客观性，但翻译时要注意调整为主动语态。)，再将后置定语拆分重组 (designed to reduce the delaying of bedtime单拆一个分句，避免信息密集。)

非限定性定语从句：

宾语：which; (指前文the delaying of bedtime，因此从句还原为：research has linked the delaying of bedtime to procrastination in general，译文的“延迟就寝与拖延存在普遍关联”就是从这里而来。) 主语：research; 谓语：has linked to; (注意是现在完成时，因此译为“既有研究”，体现出是“已有的”。这句话同时出现了一般过去时和现在完成时，翻译时注意有所体现或区分，译文能更准确。) 宾语补足语：procrastination in general;

randomised controlled trial. Adults with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder showed significant gains in cognitive executive function, including the ability to get started on tasks, while taking the stimulant lisdexamfetamine rather than a placebo.

至于药物，目前还没有任何专门针对拖延症状的药物。不过，在2021年，一项美国随机对照试验的发现耐人寻味。患有注意缺陷多动障碍（ADHD）的成年人在服用赖右苯丙胺期间，其认知执行功能出现了显著提升，包括开始着手完成任务的能力；该药物并非安慰剂，而是兴奋剂。

### 【Para.7】

These days, opportunities for procrastination are greater than before. Many people work from home, out of the boss's sight. Smartphones offer endless **distractions**. In one review published in 2022, each of the 18 studies assessed linked excessive smartphone use to procrastination. **Scrolling** often delays bedtime, too. Lack of sleep **impedes** executive function, leading to more failures of self-regulation. It would be helpful if the scientists involved could stop **dawdling**.

如今，拖延的机会比以往更多。许多人居家办公，远离老板的视线。智能手机的干扰又无穷无尽。在2022年发表的一项综述中，纳入评估的18项研究全都发现，过度使用智能手机与拖延行为存在关联。刷手机也常常会导致就寝时间延迟。睡眠不足会妨碍执行功能，进而导致更多的自我调节失败。要是研究拖延的

## ➤ 写作积累

1. ( Para. 4 ) Those randomly assigned to 12 weeks of strength training, high-intensity interval training, or a combination of the two, showed "significant reductions" in putting things off.

本句中的 putting things off 表示 "to delay or postpone doing a task or dealing with a situation until a later time, often because you do not want to do it right now"，即“拖延做事 / 把该做的事情往后拖”，例如，Stop putting things off and start working on your project now. 别再拖延了，现在就开始做你的项目吧。此外，还有以下表达可以表示类似的含义：

drag one's feet idiom to delay action, stall, or be intentionally slow because you do not want to do something 故意拖拉；迟迟不采取行动

He's dragging his feet about writing his thesis. 他对写论文这件事磨磨蹭蹭、迟迟不动手。

sit on one's hands idiom to do nothing, take no action, or fail to help when a situation or problem needs attention 袖手旁观；什么也不做

We can't just sit on our hands while the problem gets worse. 问题越来越严重，我们不能什么都不做。

2. ( Para. 6 ) Adults with attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder showed significant gains in cognitive executive function, including the ability to get started on tasks, while taking the stimulant lisdexamfetamine rather than a placebo.

本句中的 get started on 表示 "to begin doing, working on, or dealing with a task, project, or activity"，即“开始着手做某项任务，开始行动”，例如，How do I get started on learning a new language? 我该如何开始学一门新语言呢？此外，还有以下习语可以表示相同的含义，以供写作时选用：

get down to (something or doing something) idiom to start giving your full attention, effort, or serious focus to a specific task or problem 开始认真处理，着手做某事

It's time to get down to writing the report. 是时候开始写报告了

set about idiom to start doing or dealing with a task, or physically attacking someone 开始着手...某事

She immediately set about solving the problem. 她立即开始着手解决这个问题。

科学家们自己也能动作快点，那就再好不过了。